

Bass does not thump like sealed earbuds, but it has enough punch for an open-ear design, more so than some alternatives like the Nothing Ear (Open). Vocals come through clearly. You can hear texture and breath in Johnny Cash's voice in *Hurt*, though the vocals are not pushed. Instruments often sit ahead of them. With tracks like *Centuries* by Fall Out Boy, the presentation stays energetic without fatigue. High-frequency detail is more restrained than in the Nothing Ear (Open).

On podcasts, audiobooks, and softer music, the Buds Clip tuning is completely adequate. On heavier tracks or bass-centric genres, you won't get the same impact as in-ear buds, but that's the compromise open-ear design asks you to make.

Spatial audio adds a slight sense of width, but it also pushes vocals further back and reduces clarity. I preferred keeping it turned off. There were no noticeable latency issues while watching videos or casual gaming.

Ambient awareness is built in by design, not something you toggle. That means you never feel cut off. This comes in handy in daily Indian environments, like on a crowded street or while waiting for a metro announcement. I could comfortably watch movies at home and still hear when someone talks to me.

BATTERY LIFE AND CHARGING

Endurance is not the Realme Buds



Clip's strongest suit. That said, the battery life I got is respectable for this price. The buds run for about 5 hours and 30 minutes with AAC and 80% volume. That's on the lower end compared to ANC in-ear earphones like the Realme Buds Air 8 and even clip-style open-ear earbuds like the Huawei FreeClip.

VERDICT

In everyday use, Realme Buds Clip's open design proves genuinely practical. At low volumes or with the music off, you can fearlessly walk on busy Indian roads, move around the house, or sit in an office. You hear your surroundings naturally, without needing a transpar-

ency mode. For gyms, workspaces, and casual home listening, this feels safer and more relaxed than sealed earbuds.

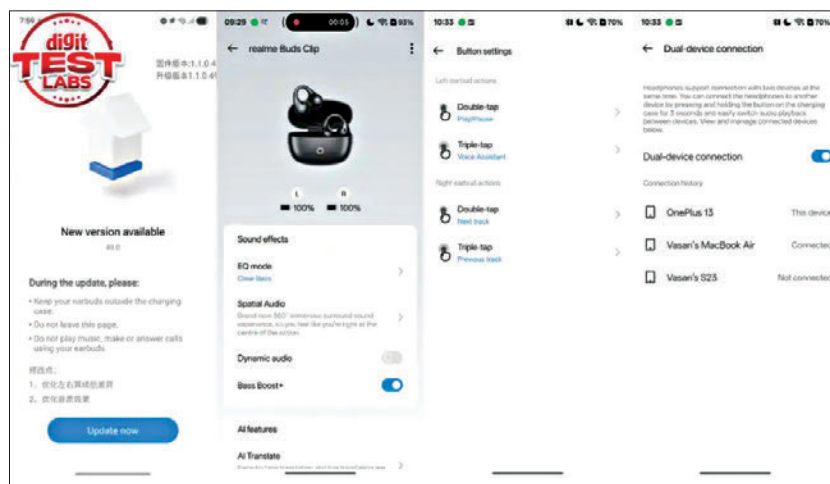
The Realme Link app and features like spatial audio, 45ms low-latency Game Mode, dual-device connection, and the ability to change touch controls make them feel closer to Realme's mainstream earbuds.

The Realme Buds Clip are not for everyone, and that's okay. Sound is airy and enjoyable, but not very immersive. Vocals are clear, instruments are softened, and the bass has punch for an open design, but not the weight you get from ANC buds like the Realme Buds Air 8. Compared to in-ear options, the music also loses loudness and detail.

There are also other practical limits you should be aware of. That design may not be for everyone, and because of it, some sound leakage is inevitable. Loud traffic and engine noise remain audible and can clash with the audio. Battery life is on the lower side, and less than some ANC and open-ear alternatives.

So, should you buy the Realme Buds Clip knowing these unavoidable trade-offs? Yes, if comfort, ear health, and situational awareness matter more to you than isolation. They make sense if you find in-ear earbuds fatiguing, or if you want to not be disconnected from your surroundings. They are not meant to replace ANC earbuds for travel or immersive listening.

—G. S. Vasan



SPECIFICATIONS

Drivers: 11mm dual-magnet dynamic drivers |
Codecs: SBC and AAC | IP Rating: IP55 | Earbud
Battery: 45 mAh | Case Battery: 530 mAh |
Charging: USB Type-C | Connectivity: Bluetooth
5.4 | Latency: 45 ms | Total Playback: 36 Hrs
with Charging Case

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